

Yuqi Song

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Professional Experience

The Hong Kong University of Science and Technology (Guangzhou) Guangzhou, China
Climate Change and Carbon Neutrality (CNCC) Thrust, Society Hub
Assistant Professor From July 2025

Harvard University, The Department of Organismic and Evolutionary Biology Cambridge, MA
Associate From July 2025

Harvard University, The Salata Institute for Climate and Sustainability Cambridge, MA
Postdoctoral Fellow 2023-2025

Education

The University of Chicago, Harris School of Public Policy Chicago, IL
Ph.D. in Public Policy Studies June 2023

The University of Chicago, Booth School of Business Chicago, IL
Master of Business Administration March 2017

Massachusetts Institute of Technology Cambridge, MA
Bachelor of Science in Mathematics and Economics June 2014
Minor in Chemistry and Management Science

Areas of Interest

Environmental and Energy Economics, Climate Economics, Chinese Economy, Applied Microeconomics, Development Economics, Labor Economics.

Publications

“The effect of the end-number license plate driving restriction on reducing air pollution in China”, Yuqi Song, *China Economic Review* 87 (2024): 102252.

“The value of weather forecasts: evidence from labor responses to accurate versus inaccurate temperature forecasts in China”, Yuqi Song, *Journal of Environmental Economics and Management* 125 (2024): 102970.

“Possible underestimation of the coal-fired power plants to air pollution in China”, Zhixiong Weng, Yuqi Song, Cuiyun Cheng, Dan Tong, Meng Xu, Minghao Wang, and Yang Xie, *Resources, Conservation and Recycling* 198 (2023): 107208.

“Forecasting energy demand, structure, and CO₂ emission: a case study of Beijing, China”, Zhixiong Weng, Yuqi Song, Hao Ma, Zhong Ma, and Tingting Liu *Environment, Development and Sustainability* 25, no. 9 (2023): 10369-10391.

“Convergence of eigenvalues to the support of the limiting measure in critical beta matrix models”, Chenjie Fan, Alice Guionnet, Yuqi Song, Andi Wang, *Random Matrices: Theory and Applications* 4, no. 03 (2015): 1550013.

Working Papers

Defending the Coasts: Seawalls, Typhoons, and Adapting to Sea-Level Rise, with Yichun Fan and Rongjie Zhang.

The Cost of Caution: Asymmetric Safety-Efficiency Trade-offs in Aviation under Tropical Cyclones, with Youwei Xu.

Selection and Over-Crediting in Forest-Based Carbon Offset Projects: A Comparison of Regulated and Voluntary Carbon Markets, with Joseph E. Aldy, N. Michele Holbrook, Xiaojie Gao and Jonathan Thompson.

Forecasts and Adaptation to Smokes: Evidence from Residential Electricity and Water Consumption under Smoke Exposure and Smoke Forecasts in California.

Breaking the Norms: The Environmental and Economic Impacts of Central Environmental Inspections under Local Government-Corporate Collusion in China, with Zhixiong Weng and Qingfeng Liu.

The Value of Accurate Weather Forecasts: Social Sentiment Responses Reflected in Social Media in China (*MIT Center for Real Estate Research Paper 21/20 (2021)*).

Arctic Air-Mass Displacement and Reduced Mid-Latitude Wintertime Temperature Variability under Climate Change, with Ivan Higuera-Mendieta, Amanda Farah, Claire Valva, Jim Franke, Noboru Nakamura and Elisabeth Moyer (*NRT Program in Data Science for Energy and Environmental Research Paper*).

The Development of China's Energy System: An Interpretation Using the Sankey Diagram, with Wenjia Ma, Elisabeth Moyer and Yunzhang Hu.

Work in Progress

The Efficiency of Typhoon Forecasts: Evidence from China's Public Typhoon Alert System, with Zijun Liu and Zhuotao Lu.

Development and Conservation: Evidence from Desertification and Related Sand Storm Impacts in China, with Claire Fan and Ashton Pallottini.

The Efficiency of Carbon Offset Market and the Role of Rating Firms, with Joseph E. Aldy.

The Value of Accurate Weather Forecasts: The Impacts of Accurate Temperature Forecasts on Road Congestion in China.

Fellowship and Honor

Asia-Pacific Journal of Risk and Insurance (APJRI) Research Excellence Award, MRS International Risk Conference 2026.

Salata Institute Postdoctoral Fellowship, Harvard University, 2023-2025.

EPIC-China Research Fund, Energy Policy Institute at the University of Chicago, 2023-2025.

Harris Public Policy Fellowship for PhD Candidates, The University of Chicago Harris School of Public Policy, 2018-2023.

DRW Graduate Fellowship in Economics and Policy, Energy Policy Institute at the University of Chicago, 2018-2023.

MIT Sustainable Urbanization Lab Summer Research Paper Fellowship, MIT Sustainable Urbanization Lab, June 2021-September 2021.

National Research Traineeship (NRT) Program in Computational Data Science to Advance Research at the Energy-Environment Nexus at the University of Chicago, National Science Foundation, July 2018-September 2021.

Phi Beta Kappa, Massachusetts Institute of Technology Department of Economics, 2014.

Research Experience

Energy Policy Institute at the University of Chicago, China Center (EPIC-China)

The University of Chicago Beijing Center and Chinese Center for Disease Control and Prevention, Beijing, China

Research Assistant

June 2019-August 2019

Energy Policy Institute at the University of Chicago (EPIC) Climate Impact Lab

The University of Chicago, Chicago, IL

Research Assistant, the EPIC Pre-Doctoral Fellowship Program

February 2017-August 2018

Department of Economics, Massachusetts Institute of Technology and National Bureau of Economics Research

Cambridge, MA

Research Assistant

May 2012-June 2014

Teaching Experience

The Hong Kong University of Science and Technology (Guangzhou)

Instructor

From 2025

Courses: (PhD level, CNCC 5300/IPEN 5900) Policy and Technology for Carbon Neutrality, Green Technology and Innovation (master level, CNGF5010).

The University of Chicago, Harris School of Public Policy

Teaching Assistant

January 2020-March 2022

Courses: Cost-Benefit Analysis (for MPP students, Winter 2020, Winter 2021) and Environmental Economics (for MPP and undergraduate students, Spring 2020, Winter 2022).

Environmental Data Science Virtual Bootcamps 2020, The University of Chicago

Moderator

September 2020

Course: Statistics for Research.

Conference Presentations

2026: ASSA Annual Conference 2026, The 7th World Congress of Environmental and Resource Economists (WCERE 2026), 2026 MRS International Risk Conference.

2025: AERE Summer Conference, NBER Summer Institute Environmental & Energy Economics (Egg-Timer Session).

2024: ASSA Annual Conference (Poster), Midwest Economic Association Annual Conference, Eastern Economic Association Annual Conference, Western Economic Association Annual Conference.

2023: AERE OSWEET, LSE Environment Week, CU Environmental & Resource Economics Workshop, Xi'an Jiaotong University Jinhe Center for Economic Research Environmental Seminar, CASS PhD Workshop.

2020-2022: American Geophysical Union Fall Meeting (2020, Poster), The Second Graduates Forum of the Global Alliance of Universities on Climate (2020), The Third Graduates Forum of the Global Alliance of Universities on Climate (2021, Video Presentation).

Review Activity

Frontiers of Environmental Science & Engineering; China Economic Review; Econometrica; Climate Change; Journal of Environmental Economics and Management; Humanities and Social Sciences Communications; Scientific Reports; Weather, Climate and Society; Nature Climate Change.

Skills

Language: Chinese (Mandarin and Cantonese), English.

Computer: R, STATA, Matlab, Mathematica, Python, Bash, GIS, Git, Google Cloud, Google Earth Engine, LaTeX, Microsoft Office (WORD, EXCEL, PowerPoint), EXCEL DecisionTools Suite, Keynote, VB, Pascal, Photoshop, JavaScript, HTML, Linux.

Chemistry Lab: Titration, Chromatography, Distillation, Crystallization, Extraction.